Version3 26th November 2020

BCUHB Request for supply of off label use of TOCILIZUMAB for a named ADULT patient admitted to ICU with COVID-19 pneumonia

Patient name:		**Site:**	
Hospital number:		**Ward**	
Named consultant:		**DOB:**	

	Please ensure you can answer ALL QUESTIONS indicating that the patient meets the following criteria:	**Yes**
1	The patient is ≥18 years old.	
2	The patient has been admitted to ICU/HDU within the last 24 hours with severe pneumonia.	
3	The patient has COVID-19 infection either confirmed by microbiological testing or by MDT review of patient's clinical and radiological features suggesting COVID-19.	
4	The patient requires organ support. (i.e. high-flow nasal oxygen, CPAP, non-invasive/ invasive mechanical ventilation, receiving vasopressor/ inotrope infusions).	
5	The respiratory support was started in the last 24 hours.	
6	The patient has not received a dose of tocilizumab during this hospital admission nor are they on long-term therapy with tocilizumab prior to this hospital admission.	
7	The patient does not have any known hypersensitivity to tocilizumab.	
8	The patient's baseline AST or ALT is not greater than 5 x Upper Limit of Normal (**Use with caution** if LFTs are 1.5 x ULN)	
9	The patient doesn't have a co-existing infection (other than COVID-19) that might be worsened by tocilizumab[1]	
10	The patient's baseline platelet count is greater than 50 x 10^9/L.	
11	The patient's baseline absolute neutrophil count is greater than 2 x 10^9/L.	
12	The patient does not have a pre-existing condition or treatment resulting in ongoing immunosuppression.	
13	The patient is not pregnant.[2]	
14	The patient's eGFR, LFTs and FBC will be monitored during treatment (as clinically appropriate).	
15	The MDT will report adverse events, serious adverse events, and special situation reports to MHRA Coronavirus Yellow Card.	
16	Data collection requirements will be met through the ISARIC WHO CCP-UK case report form (CRF).	

DOSE: Dose is 8mg/kg to be administered as an intravenous infusion (**see dose banding overleaf**).

- The total dose should not exceed 800mg.
- The Tocilizumab Concentrate **MUST** be diluted before administration. **See over leaf for preparation instruction.**
- Tocilizumab must be administered as an intravenous infusion via a central or peripheral line over a one-hour period.
- **Infusion rate of the diluted preparation:** 10ml/hr for first 10mins then 130ml/hr for the remaining 45mins followed by a 20ml sodium chloride 0.9% flush.
- **A single dose is to be administered, with the option to repeat a dose in 12-24 hours after the initial dose if there has not been sufficient clinical improvement.**
- **Tocilizumab should not be infused concomitantly in the same IV line with other medications.**

Dose banding

Weight* Rounded to nearest whole kg	**Dose**	**Volume of** concentrate[3] solution to be drawn up, diluted and then infused
<41 kg	8mg/kg, Dose rounded to nearest 20mg	
≥41 and ≤ 45 kg	360mg	18mL
≥ 46 and ≤ 55 kg	400mg	20mL
≥ 56 and ≤ 65 kg	480mg	24mL
≥ 66 and ≤ 80 kg	600mg	30mL
≥ 81 and ≤ 90 kg	680mg	34mL
≥ 91kg	800mg	40mL

Preparation guide:

Face shields in addition to standard PPE should be worn.

1. Calculate the volume (mL) of tocilizumab[3] concentrate required for the dose.
2. Withdraw this volume from a 100mL sodium chloride 0.9% infusion bag.
3. Discard the volume withdrawn from the sodium chloride 0.9% infusion bag. This will ensure that the final volume is 100mL after the drug has been added.
4. Withdraw the required volume of tocilizumab concentrate for the patient dose.
5. Add the tocilizumab concentrate to the 100mL sodium chloride 0.9% infusion bag.
6. Gently invert the bag to mix, **do not shake**.
7. Inspect the bag. Only bags which are clear to opalescent, colourless to pale yellow and free of visible particles can be infused.
8. Prime the line with the tocilizumab infusion then administer infusion intravenously over 60 minutes via a central or peripheral line. **The infusion speed must be 10mL per hour for 15 minutes and then increased to 130mL per hour for the next 45 minutes. Flush line at the same rate as the tocilizumab infusion with 10-20mL of sodium chloride 0.9%.**

Name of Applicant			
Contact phone no.		**Bleep number**	
Date			

Please email completed form to Teena.Grenier@wales.nhs.uk for DTG information, send a copy to the pharmacy when requesting a supply, and file a copy within the patient notes.

1. Any active, severe infection other than COVID-19; caution is advised when considering the use of tocilizumab in patients with a history of recurring or chronic infections or with underlying conditions which may predispose patients to infections.
2. The REMAP-CAP trial excluded pregnant women, whereas the RECOVERY trial has included pregnant women. SPC for Tocilizumab states: "Women of childbearing potential must use effective contraception during and up to 3 months after treatment. There are no adequate data from the use of tocilizumab in pregnant women. A study in animals has shown an increased risk of spontaneous abortion/embryo-foetal death at a high dose. The potential risk for humans is unknown. Tocilizumab should not be used during pregnancy unless clearly necessary."
3. SPC link: https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/product/6673/smpc
4. Interim Position Statement: Tocilizumab for patients admitted to ICU with COVID-19 pneumonia (adults). 25th November 2020. https://www.cas.mhra.gov.uk/ViewandAcknowledgment/ViewAlert.aspx?AlertID=103116